

Ira A Fulton Schools of Engineering Required Syllabus Itemsⁱ

The distribution of a course information sheet or syllabus is required for all university undergraduate courses and strongly recommended for graduate courses. The syllabus is a statement of intent and serves as an implicit agreement between the instructor and the student.

1. Contact Information

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2. Office Hours

TTh 5:50 - 6:50PM, in classroom or BYE 566

Other times: by appointment only via email

3. Course Description:

Social media allows a passive reader (or an average Joe) to become an active producer (or a shining online star), creating a phenomenal landscape change in terms of Web-based activities. With various social media (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Snapchat etc.), people can share content, opinions, insights, experiences, perspectives, and media themselves, as well as producing many new media. Social networks emerge with the pervasive use of social media. We will briefly introduce the background of social computing including concepts and principles such as small world, random networks, scale-free networks, laws and distributions (normal distribution, Zipf's law, power law), search in networks, propagation of influence and trust, diffusion (epidemics), social recommendation, collective wisdom, collaborative filtering. We will learn what representative data collection techniques are, and how to use collected data to help achieve tasks such as recommendation, cross reference, attention retention, and identifying key performance indicators. We will study issues like public opinion, sentiment analysis, privacy, trust, and reputation. This course aims to introduce the state-of-the art developments in participatory social media techniques, social networks and analysis, network analysis and graph theory, information extraction, link analysis, and social media mining, to study emerging problems, and to learn innovatively applying multidisciplinary approaches to problem solving. The ultimate goal is to sharpen problem solving and critical thinking skills of our senior and graduate students, and prepare them with this unique set of expertise for the increasing demands in IT industry and for in depth advanced research.

4. Enrollment Requirements

CSE 471 or equivalent, or CSE 310 Data Structures and Algorithms

5. Course Objectives

See Course Description.

6. Expected Learning Outcomes

See Course Description.

7. ASU SYNC COURSES

This course is in person

8. Grade Policies

A-E with +/-

3-4 Homework assignments (12%)

2 Projects (10+20%)

2 exams or equivalent (55%)

Class participation, Quizzes (3% plus up to 2% extra credit)

9. Absence policies and the conditions under which assigned work and/or tests can be made up, which should include

- a. Students are encouraged to participate in every class as this is the easiest way to learn in this course.
- b. During classes, some impromptu quizzes will be given to (1) encourage all students to be in class in person, (2) reinforce some concepts we learned earlier, and (3) for students to earn attendance points.

Mandatory statements for absences

- c. excused absences related to religious observances/practices that are in accord with [ACD 304–04](#), “Accommodation for Religious Practices”
- d. excused absences related to university sanctioned events/activities that are in accord with [ACD 304–02](#), “Missed Classes Due to University-Sanctioned Activities”
- e. Excused absences related to missed class due to military line-of-duty activities that are in accord with [ACD 304–11](#), “Missed Class Due to Military Line-of-Duty Activities,” and SSM 201–18, “Accommodating Active Duty Military”

10. Lists of any required readings, assignments, examinations, special materials and extracurricular activities

- a. [Required textbook]
Social Media Mining: An Introduction, Reza Zafarani, Ali Abassi, and Huan Liu, by Cambridge University Press, 2014 (A **free pdf version** is available on the instructor’s homepage).
- b. ASU SYNC requirements

This class is in person

- c. Assignments: See Grade Policies
- d. Course Itinerary: Available on Canvas

11. Policy regarding expected classroom behavior (e.g., use of pagers, cell phones, recording devices)

No cell phones

12. Academic Integrity

Mandatory Statement

Students in this class must adhere to ASU's academic integrity policy, which can be found at <https://provost.asu.edu/academic-integrity/policy>). Students are responsible for reviewing this policy and understanding each of the areas in which academic dishonesty can occur. In addition, all engineering students are expected to adhere to both the ASU Academic Integrity [Honor Code](#) and the Fulton Schools of Engineering [Honor Code](#). All academic integrity violations will be reported to the Fulton Schools of Engineering Academic Integrity Office (AIO). The AIO maintains record of all violations and has access to academic integrity violations committed in all other ASU college/schools.

Use of Generative AI

General Guidelines

- 1.1. The use of generative AI, such as ChatGPT, is permitted as an auxiliary tool to assist students in their course projects and report writing.
- 1.2. Students are strictly prohibited from using generative AI for any homework assignments or assessments unless explicitly announced by the instructor.
- 1.3. Any use of generative AI, such as ChatGPT, must be accompanied by proper citation and acknowledgment to avoid plagiarism. Proper citation includes referencing the name of the AI model, the organization or platform providing the AI service, and any relevant publication details if applicable.

Acceptable Use of Generative AI

- 2.1. Students are allowed to employ generative AI to augment their understanding of course concepts and generate creative ideas to enhance their project work.
- 2.2. Generative AI can be utilized as a supportive tool for writing sections of reports, creating supplementary materials, or brainstorming ideas, as long as it aligns with the learning objectives of the course.

Prohibited Use of Generative AI

- 3.1. Students are not permitted to rely on generative AI to complete any portion of their assigned homework (including quizzes), or other graded assessments. All work submitted for assessment must be the result of the student's independent efforts.
- 3.2. Directly using generative AI to generate solutions or responses for homework assignments or examinations constitutes academic dishonesty and is subject to penalties.

Penalties for Violations

- 4.1. If a student is found to have utilized generative AI in violation of this policy, appropriate disciplinary action will be taken, as per the institution's academic integrity guidelines.
- 4.2. The violation will be reported to the Dean of Academic Affairs for further investigation and possible sanctions.

Educational Purpose of the Policy

- 5.1. This policy is aimed at promoting academic honesty, integrity, and responsible use of generative AI technology within the context of the course.
- 5.2. The use of generative AI as a supplementary tool serves to enhance the learning experience and foster creative thinking, provided it is used responsibly and ethically.

13. Copyright

Mandatory Statement

All course content and materials, including lectures (Zoom recorded lectures included), are copyrighted materials and students may not share outside the class, upload to online websites not approved by the instructor, sell, or distribute course content or notes taken during the conduct of the course (see [ACD 304-06](#), “Commercial Note Taking Services” and ABOR Policy [5-308 F.14](#) for more information).

You must refrain from uploading to any course shell, discussion board, or website used by the course instructor or other course forum, material that is not the student's original work, unless the students first comply with all applicable copyright laws; faculty members reserve the right to delete materials on the grounds of suspected copyright infringement.

14. Policy against threatening behavior, per the Student Services Manual, [SSM 104-02](#)

Mandatory statement

Students, faculty, staff, and other individuals do not have an unqualified right of access to university grounds, property, or services. Interfering with the peaceful conduct of university-related business or activities or remaining on campus grounds after a request to leave may be considered a crime. All incidents and allegations of violent or threatening conduct by an ASU student (whether on- or off-campus) must be reported to the ASU Police Department (ASU PD) and the Office of the Dean of Students.

15. Warning of Offensive Class Materials (if appropriate),

[your written warning that some course content may be deemed offensive by some students and how to bring this to the attention of the instructor or, alternatively, to the unit chair or director]

16. Disability Accommodations

Mandatory statement

Suitable accommodations will be made for students having disabilities. Students needing accommodations must register with the ASU Disabilities Resource Center and provide documentation of that registration to the instructor. Students should communicate the need for an accommodation in sufficient time for it to be properly arranged. See [ACD 304-08](#) Classroom and Testing Accommodations for Students with Disabilities.

17. Harassment and Sexual Discrimination

Mandatory statement

Arizona State University is committed to providing an environment free of discrimination, harassment, or retaliation for the entire university community, including all students, faculty members, staff employees, and guests. ASU expressly prohibits discrimination, harassment, and retaliation by employees, students, contractors, or agents of the university based on any protected status: race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, and genetic information.

Title IX is a federal law that provides that no person be excluded on the basis of sex from participation in, be denied benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity. Both Title IX and university policy make clear that sexual violence and harassment based on sex is prohibited. An individual who believes they have been subjected to sexual violence or harassed on the basis of sex can seek support, including counseling and academic support, from the university. If you or someone you know has been harassed on the

basis of sex or sexually assaulted, you can find information and resources at <https://sexualviolenceprevention.asu.edu/faqs>.

Mandated sexual harassment reporter: As a mandated reporter, I am obligated to report any information I become aware of regarding alleged acts of sexual discrimination, including sexual violence and dating violence. ASU Counseling Services, <https://eoss.asu.edu/counseling>, is available if you wish discuss any concerns confidentially and privately.

Syllabus changes: Any information in this syllabus (other than grading and absence policies) may be subject to change with reasonable advance notice.

How Long Students Should Wait for an Absent Instructor: In the event the instructor fails to indicate a time obligation, the time obligation will be 15 minutes for class sessions lasting 90 minutes or less, and 30 minutes for class sessions lasting more than 90 minutes. Students may be directed to wait longer by someone from the academic unit if they know the instructor will arrive shortly.

ⁱ required items per ASU Academic Affairs Manual policy 304 – 10 and Ira A. Fulton Schools of Engineering Dean's Academic and Student Affairs requirements.